# AcquireLocal

ACQUIRE A BUSINESS | PRESERVE A LEGACY | STRENGTHEN A COMMUNITY

ACQUIRELOCAL BROOKLYN 2026








**12 million**
businesses expected to change hands over the next 10 to 15 years as baby boomer owners retire

**$10 trillion**
in business assets at stake in this generational transition of ownership

**150**
legacy business owners, experienced professionals interested in ETA, and community partners expected in Brooklyn

Business and asset estimates: JPMorganChase

ABOUT ACQUIRELOCAL

## *What happens to a local business when its owner is ready to move on?*

*And what opportunities exist for the next generation of entrepreneurs?*

Every established business represents years of hard work, relationships, and investment. As baby boomer owners retire, an unprecedented transition is creating both challenges for established owners and opportunities for the next generation of entrepreneurs. When a longtime business closes without a successor, a neighborhood loses jobs, trusted services, and locally held wealth.

Founded by Lori Ann Pope and Dana K. Michel, AcquireLocal is an emerging initiative focused on helping established business owners understand their succession options, introducing experienced professionals interested in ETA to business ownership through acquisition, and strengthening the networks that support local businesses.

AcquireLocal Brooklyn, our inaugural event, brings these conversations together for an evening of insight, practical guidance, and meaningful connections.

### EXPLORE THE POSSIBILITIES

- Business succession planning
- Entrepreneurship through acquisition
- Financing, valuation, and buyer readiness
- Expert discussions and breakout sessions
- Networking and a Resource Fair

> *"When small businesses thrive, communities do more than survive; they flourish."*
>
> LORI ANN POPE, CO-FOUNDER, ACQUIRELOCAL

### EVENT DETAILS

**Thursday, December 3, 2026**
5:00–8:30 p.m.

**St. Francis College**
179 Livingston Street
Downtown Brooklyn, New York

**Tickets: $25**

REGISTER TODAY

Scan or visit
eventbrite.com/e/acquire-local-inaugural-event-tickets-2002596155008

### WHO'S IN THE ROOM

| | |
|---|---|
| Legacy business owners | 40% |
| Experienced professionals interested in ETA | 40% |
| Community partners | 20% |

**NOBODY WINS WHEN LOCAL BUSINESSES CLOSE.**

AGENDA

# The Evening at a Glance

**Thursday, December 3, 2026 | St. Francis College**

Two expert panels, founder stories, focused breakouts for owners and buyers, and a Resource Fair with lenders, advisors, and business-support organizations throughout the evening.



| | |
|---|---|
| **5:00–5:30 p.m.** | **Check-In, Networking, and Resource Fair** |
| **5:30–5:35 p.m.** | **Welcome**<br>Curtis L. Archer, President, Harlem Community Development Corporation |
| **5:35–5:55 p.m.** | **Opening Remarks**<br>Kim Council, Deputy Brooklyn Borough President<br>Delia Awusi, NYC Mom-and-Pop Czar, Office of the Mayor |
| **5:55–6:00 p.m.** | **My Journey to AcquireLocal**<br>Lori Ann Pope, Co-Founder, AcquireLocal |
| **6:00–6:30 p.m.** | **Panel: Passing the Baton: Inside the Deal from Handshake to Handoff**<br>Kevin Griffith, Glenmore Capital Group; Jeannie Keen, Building Transferable Businesses™; Tricia M. Taitt, FinCore<br>Moderator: Lori Ann Pope, AcquireLocal |
| **6:30–6:35 p.m.** | **My Journey to AcquireLocal**<br>Dana K. Michel, Co-Founder, AcquireLocal |
| **6:35–7:05 p.m.** | **Panel: The Lender's Lens: What It Takes to Buy Your First Business**<br>Sahra S. Halpern, Business Consortium Fund; Kris Schumacher, New Majority Capital<br>Moderator: Dana K. Michel, AcquireLocal |
| **7:05–7:35 p.m.** | **Networking and Resource Fair** |
| **7:35–8:00 p.m.** | **Breakout Sessions**<br>A: Your Legacy, Your Terms (legacy business owners)<br>B: Ready to Own? (experienced professionals) |
| **8:00–8:30 p.m.** | **Final Networking and Resource Fair** |

*Speakers and topics subject to change.*

6:00–6:30 P.M. · OPENING PANEL

## Passing the Baton

### Inside the Deal from Handshake to Handoff

Behind every successful business transition is a team of professionals. This panel brings that team together to walk through the life of a deal, from the moment a legacy owner starts thinking about what comes next to the day a new owner takes the keys. Using a sample Brooklyn business as our guide, a business broker, an independent sponsor, and a financial strategist share what each side needs to know and when: How sellers prepare their business and their finances for an exit; what buyers look for when they evaluate a company; and why clean books, clear processes, and an early start shape the value of a business and the success of its transition. Whether you're preparing to pass the baton or ready to take it, you'll leave knowing whom to call first and what to do next.

**LEARNING OBJECTIVES**

- Describe the key stages of a small business transition and the professionals who guide buyers and sellers through each one.
- Identify the first steps legacy owners can take to prepare for an exit, including organizing their financials, understanding valuation, and reducing the business's dependence on the owner.
- Recognize what buyers and investors look for during due diligence and the red flags that can slow or end a deal.

**PANELISTS**

**Kevin Griffith**
President, Glenmore Capital Group, Inc.

**Jeannie Keen, CMSBB, LCSW, PMP**
Founder, Building Transferable Businesses™

**Tricia M. Taitt**
CEO and Chief Financial Choreographer, FinCore

**MODERATOR**

**Lori Ann Pope**
Co-Founder, AcquireLocal

PROGRAM

6:35–7:05 P.M. · PANEL DISCUSSION

## The Lender's Lens

### What It Takes to Buy Your First Business

You don't have to start from scratch to become a business owner, but you do have to be ready. In this conversation, leaders in community development lending and acquisition capital share what they look for when a first-time buyer comes to them for capital. They explain the experience, credit, and cash needed to qualify; how SBA, CDFI, and seller financing can work together; and how aspiring owners can close the gaps that stand between them and their first deal. Business owners planning a transition will also hear what makes a business attractive to lenders, and why a well-prepared buyer is the key to a successful exit.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Explain the main qualifications for SBA acquisition financing, including relevant experience, credit, equity injection, and the business's cash flow.
- Compare the roles of SBA lenders, CDFIs, and acquisition-focused capital partners, and know when to approach each one.
- Identify concrete steps to become capital ready and, for business owners, the factors that make a business easier for a buyer to finance.

PANELISTS

**Sahra S. Halpern**
President, Business Consortium Fund

**Kris Schumacher**
Co-Founder and Managing Partner, New Majority Capital

MODERATOR

**Dana K. Michel**
Co-Founder, AcquireLocal

7:35–8:00 P.M. · BREAKOUT A · LEGACY BUSINESS OWNERS

## Your Legacy, Your Terms

### Planning Your Exit and Succession

You built something that matters; now it's time to decide what happens next. This small-group session is for established business owners who want to understand their options for stepping back, whether that's in one year or ten. A business broker and an experienced acquirer walk you through the realities of exit planning: What your business may be worth, what buyers look for, how to get your financials and operations in order, and the paths available to you, including sale to an outside buyer, a family member, or your own employees. Bring your questions. You'll leave with a clear picture of where you stand and the first steps toward a transition that protects your business, your employees, and your community.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Compare the main succession paths (outside sale, family transition, employee ownership) and which might fit your goals and timeline.
- Identify the factors that drive a business's value and attractiveness to buyers, and the steps that can raise both.
- Leave with a personal exit-readiness checklist and a 30-day next step.

FACILITATORS

**Jeannie Keen, CMSBB, LCSW, PMP**
Founder, Building Transferable Businesses™

**Kevin Griffith**
President, Glenmore Capital Group, Inc.

7:35–8:00 P.M. · BREAKOUT B · EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONALS

## Ready to Own?

### Testing Your Readiness and Financing Your First Business

Buying a business can be a faster, less risky road to ownership than starting from scratch, but it isn't for everyone. This hands-on session helps aspiring owners take an honest look at their readiness: Personal, professional, and financial. An acquisition capital expert explains what it really takes, including how much capital you need, how SBA, CDFI, and seller financing work, what lenders look for in a first-time buyer, and which types of businesses make strong first acquisitions. You'll leave knowing whether you're ready, what gaps to close, and what to do next.

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Assess your personal and financial readiness for acquisition using a practical self-evaluation.
- Explain the basics of acquisition financing, including down payment expectations, SBA 7(a) and CDFI loans, and seller notes, and what lenders need to see.
- Identify the kinds of businesses that suit first-time buyers and the red flags to avoid.

FACILITATOR

**Kris Schumacher**
Co-Founder and Managing Partner, New Majority Capital

## Special Guests



**Delia Awusi**
NYC Mom-and-Pop Czar
**Office of the Mayor, City of New York**
*Opening Remarks*



**Kim Council**
Deputy Borough President
**Borough of Brooklyn**
*Opening Remarks*

## Featured Speakers



**Curtis L. Archer**
President
**Harlem Community Development Corporation**
*Welcome*



**Kevin Griffith**
President
**Glenmore Capital Group, Inc.**
*Passing the Baton: Your Legacy, Your Terms*



**Sahra S. Halpern**
President
**Business Consortium Fund**
*The Lender's Lens*



**Jeannie Keen, CMSBB, LCSW, PMP**
Founder
**Building Transferable Businesses™**
*Passing the Baton: Your Legacy, Your Terms*



**Dana K. Michel**
Co-Founder
**AcquireLocal**
*Moderator, The Lender's Lens*



**Lori Ann Pope**
Co-Founder
**AcquireLocal**
*Moderator, Passing the Baton*



**Kris Schumacher**
Co-Founder and Managing Partner
**New Majority Capital**
*The Lender's Lens; Ready to Own?*



**Tricia M. Taitt**
CEO and Chief Financial Choreographer
**FinCore**
*Passing the Baton: Your Legacy, Your Terms*

## Resource Fair Partners

Acquire Local · Building Transferable Businesses · Brooklyn Chamber of Commerce · FinCore (Engage. Educate. Elevate.) · NYC Business Solutions · SBA U.S. Small Business Administration

Open throughout the evening, the Resource Fair connects attendees with lending, exit-planning, acquisition-readiness, and community resources. Additional partners to be announced.

SHARE WITH YOUR NETWORK

### Help us fill the room with the right people.

- Forward this guide to small business clients, colleagues, and employee resource groups.
- Invite owners thinking about succession and professionals exploring ownership through acquisition.
- Share our ready-to-post social copy and graphics; we are happy to send the promo kit.
- Join us on December 3 and meet Brooklyn's small business community in person.

WHAT'S NEXT

### The 2027 AcquireLocal Roadshow

Insights from Brooklyn will shape a 2027 roadshow to cities across the country, along with events in other New York City boroughs, the tri-state area, and rural communities. Founding and presenting partnership opportunities are available.

Register for December 3
eventbrite.com/e/acquire-local-inaugural-event-tickets-2002596155008

**Dana K. Michel**, Co-Founder
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**Lori Ann Pope**, Co-Founder
Content curation, educational resources, and event production
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